

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in case management, client communication, document drafting and deadline-driven file handling at BCLP, Citizens Advice East Berkshire and Q-Legal. Experienced in advising clients on complex and sensitive matters, preparing procedural documents, maintaining organised case files and translating legal requirements into clear guidance. Based in Maidenhead, with a particular interest in client-facing advisory work and developing a career in private client practice.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies legal and evidential issues
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points on clients' behalf
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients, including on procedural requirements and available options

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; conducted legal research; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated translations with an external provider
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Prepared client notes; maintained matter records via iManage; managed large volumes of confidential documents across concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters